

A black and white photograph of the atomic bombing of Nagasaki on August 9, 1945. The image shows a massive, billowing mushroom cloud rising from the city, with a thick column of smoke and debris at its base. The sky is filled with smaller, scattered clouds. The text "The Bomb" is superimposed in white, sans-serif font over the upper part of the mushroom cloud.

The Bomb

Do the ends justify the means?

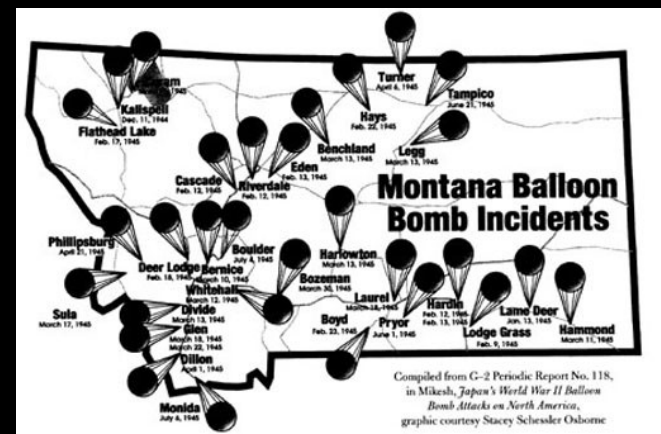
“Fun” Japanese War Facts



Strength

10-man weather station
1-6 dogs
3 aircraft^[1]

+500 Special Naval
Landing Forces (Initial
force)
5,183-5,400 civilians and
soldiers (Occupation)^[2]



Background

- The US had retaken Pacific Islands through intense fighting.
- China and USA give ultimatum at Potsdam conference (more on that in Soc 30)
- US has been developing and testing atomic bomb throughout war.
- German surrender on May 7, 1945



https://youtu.be/Tl3_0D2h8BY

The Event



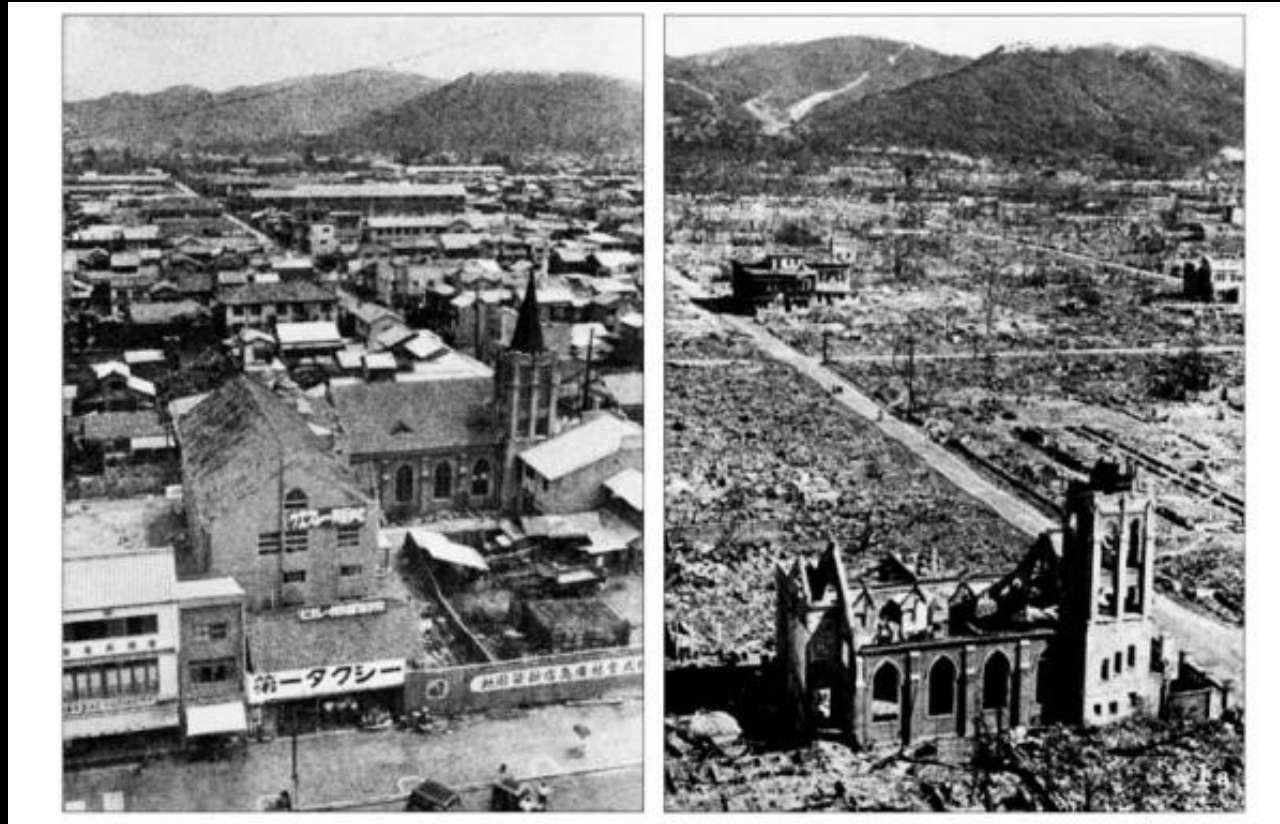
A post-war "Little Boy" model.

Was it necessary?

80,000 – People died instantly in Hiroshima

192,020 - Total number of those killed in Hiroshima, combining those killed instantly and those killed from radiation and other aftermath

70,000 - Number of people killed instantly in Nagasaki



August 9, 1945

Dear Dick:

I read your telegram of August seventh with a lot of interest.

I know that Japan is a terribly cruel and uncivilized nation in warfare but I can't bring myself to believe that, because they are beasts, we should ourselves act in the same manner.

For myself, I certainly regret the necessity of wiping out whole populations because of the "pigheadedness" of the leaders of a nation and, for your information, I am not going to do it unless it is absolutely necessary. It is my opinion that after the Russians enter into war the Japanese will very shortly fold up.

My object is to save as many American lives as possible but I also have a humane feeling for the women and children in Japan.

Sincerely yours,

HARRY S. TRUMAN

Honorable Richard B. Russell
Winder
Georgia

x190-Misc.

692-A

August 11, 1945

My dear Mr. Cavert:

I appreciated very much your telegram of August ninth.

Nobody is more disturbed over the use of Atomic bombs than I am but I was greatly disturbed over the unwarranted attack by the Japanese on Pearl Harbor and their murder of our prisoners of war. The only language they seem to understand is the one we have been using to bombard them.

When you have to deal with a beast you have to treat him as a beast. It is most regrettable but nevertheless true.

Sincerely yours,

HARRY S. TRUMAN

Mr. Samuel McCrea Cavert
General Secretary
Federal Council of
The Churches of Christ in America
New York City, New York

x692-A-Misc.

x PP7 185

x 197-Misc

x 400 Hawaii
Pearl Harbor

x190-2

x197

x PP7 33

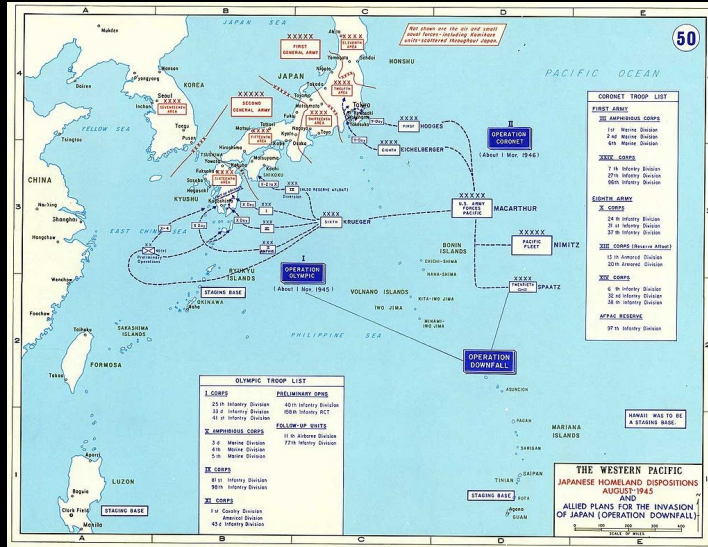
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A Couple Definitions

- Genocide – the killing of members of a national, ethnic, racial or religious group; and deliberately inflicting on the group conditions that bring about its physical destruction
- War Crimes – Willful killing, torture or inhumane treatment; willfully causing great suffering; and intentionally directing attacks against a civilian population or against people involved in a humanitarian or peacekeeping mission.
- Crimes Against Humanity – Widespread systematic attacks against a civilian population. Including murder, enslavement, deportation, kidnapping, apartheid, etc.

The Bombs were Needed



War Culture

Invasion?

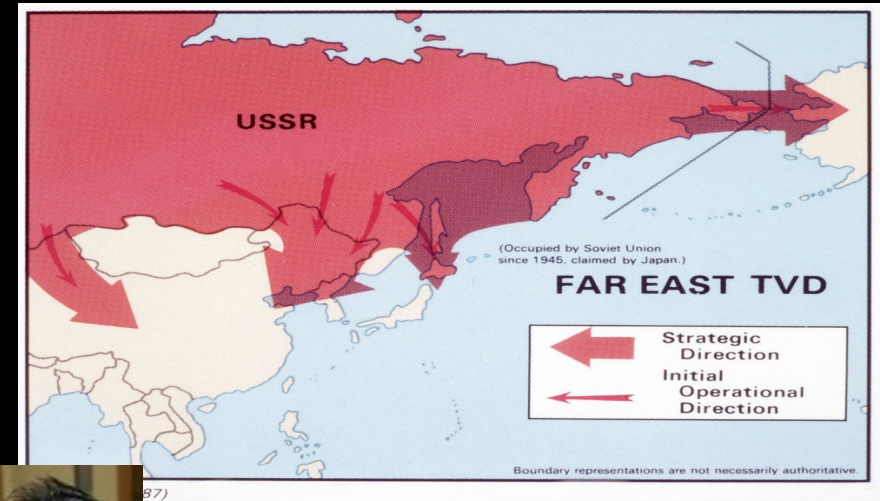


The real reason?

The Bombs were a War Crime



Civilian Targets



Other Military Options



Long Term Impacts

A-Bomb

- Needed
- Excessive